

Hypertension Management Guide

HYPERTENSION MANAGEMENT GUIDE

What is High Blood Pressure?

Hypertension, or high blood pressure, is a common condition where the force of blood against artery walls is too high, usually 140/90 mmHg or higher.

Blood Pressure Categories:

- Normal: Less than 120/80 mmHg
- Elevated: Systolic 120-129 and Diastolic less than 80
- Stage 1 Hypertension: Systolic 130-139 or Diastolic 80-89
- Stage 2 Hypertension: Systolic 140 or higher or Diastolic 90 or higher

Causes:

Primary Hypertension (90-95% of cases):

- No identifiable secondary cause
- Often related to genetics, age, and lifestyle factors

Secondary Hypertension:

- Kidney disease
- Thyroid problems
- Sleep apnea
- Certain medications

Risk Factors:

- Age (risk increases with age)
- Family history
- Obesity
- Excessive alcohol use
- High sodium diet
- Stress
- Physical inactivity

Treatment Options:

Lifestyle Changes:

- DASH diet (low sodium, high potassium)
- Regular aerobic exercise (150 minutes/week)
- Weight loss if overweight
- Limit alcohol
- Stress management
- Quit smoking

Medications:

- ACE inhibitors
- Beta-blockers
- Calcium channel blockers
- Diuretics
- ARBs (Angiotensin II receptor blockers)

Prevention:

- Check blood pressure regularly
- Keep a blood pressure log
- Home monitoring devices
- Regular doctor visits